

skin and tell you the ways in which Team Digit hates some aspects of technology. Of course, this being our editorial opinion means you're likely to disagree, or think of 20, or 200 other things about technology that irritate you more than the things on our list. Write in and tell us if that's the case, and we're happy to feature your lists of tech terrors in upcoming issues or online on digit.in.

Without further ado though, let's get to reading about 20 things about tech and geek culture that really p*ss off team digit, and why we think it's ruined so many things for all of us. In no particular order...

■ SEARCH AND DISCOVER

Yes, we realise Google has used those two words to describe their own products, but here we're talking more about the concept of searching for something and discovering content, ideas and more online. Used to be a time in the 90s when finding something online was a pain, and of course content was limited. We probably consume more information in a day now than most people would in a year, just 20 years ago! Think about that! That's orders of magnitude of difference in complexity for algorithms to work their magic and throw up results to us. And that's the problem. While you certainly don't want the general public to be exposed to the hundreds of millions of spam sites out there that are just filled with nonsensical content and perhaps even malware, it also means the same filters are being used for you, a technology geek. And those filters are not just blocking out malware, but also legitimate content, based on some filters and rules that a company somewhere has decided for you.

The strength of the internet has always been the sheer amount of diversity it has, and people being exposed to new ideas and concepts. That's being rendered pointless because the gatekeepers of the internet have decided that they want to profile us and turn us into a number. Algorithms run in the background of everything, tracking every little thing you do, from where and what you

click, and even what you don't, what URLs you visit, what you Like on social media, what you ignore... everything! All of that data is logged into a system (or ten thousand systems), and then computed in a heartbeat and a number or equation spat out, which puts you in a group of supposedly like-minded people who ought to all like the same things. Then you enter a search term, or scroll through social media, and all of this number crunching results in stuff being shown to you based on what others liked, or what the system thinks you might like. And it's a never-ending cycle of tweaking being done to algorithms and data sets, because every action you do adds even more data points to the data set, which changes it ever so slightly. Whether you tap on something or not, if you just scroll past a video or watch it in its entirety, the search terms you enter... the system constantly updates the number or equation it stores about you (and the set of people just like you), and generates results – search results, posts on a social media news feed, videos, images, music, research papers, etc. – all in an attempt to get you to spend even more time on their site, because your time is not just your money, but their money too!

The end result? Everyone is pushing you towards often brainless activities, and is not really bothered if your brain or even your soul is being nurtured.

In fact, doctors and scientists have been worried about this for some time now, and some authors have even suggested that algorithms threaten our very ideas of democracy by being biased against the marginalised or poor, certain minorities, and perhaps may even promote racism! The real problem is that since algorithms are designed to break people into groups of all sizes, because their job is to focus on the similarities between people, they are inherently designed to create bias, filter bubbles, and increase divisiveness by dividing people into groups.

Now, add to this the fact that all of these algorithms are proprietary, and therefore secret – which also means

Let's get one thing straight, we're not going to sit here trying to be edgy, telling you why technology sucks, and how we'd all be much better off without it. That would be hypocritical since every member of Team Digit lives and breathes technology, and are often accused of loving it more than our families! And that's where the problems begin perhaps, for some of us...

The technology revolution of the past 50 years has completely changed the way we live – for better or worse. In fact, people who are alive today, and over 60 years old, will be able to tell you how drastic that change has been for them. If you're lucky enough to have grandparents over the age of 80 alive today, they probably think of you as an alien – what with your constant need to look at a screen and be absorbing information by the bucketload...

While overall, technology has turned out to be the greatest thing mankind ever invented, and allows us to have everything we take for granted now, and also helps us speed up research and development by orders of magnitude, it's not without its flaws. In fact, perhaps calling technology flawed is the wrong way of looking at it, since it's merely a tool that we use. You wouldn't call a hammer a bad invention just because someone used one to break the glass on your car to steal something, would you?

Perhaps it's not technology at all that's flawed, and just us humans who are inherently imperfect, and always seem to gravitate towards chaos. Either way, the new world that's governed by technology has its flaws, and this article aims to get under the